

Child Care & Homeschooling

Need affordable child care so you can work or study — or thinking about homeschooling? There's real help with both. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Child care help can make work or school possible. Many families who qualify never apply. The programs below are free to apply for — start with your state's child care office.

1 Help Paying for Child Care

Government programs lower or cover the cost of care.

☐ Child Care Financial Assistance (CCDF)

Your state can help pay for child care if you're working or in school. Find your state's program.

→ childcare.gov/consumer-education/get-help-paying-for-child-care

☐ Head Start & Early Head Start

Free early education and care for eligible families with young children.

→ www.acf.hhs.gov/ohs/about/head-start

2 Find Quality Care

Tools to find and check child care providers.

☐ Childcare.gov — Find Care

Find and compare licensed child care options in your area.

→ childcare.gov/state-resources

☐ Child Tax Credit & Dependent Care Credit

Tax credits that put money back in your pocket for child and care costs.

→ www.irs.gov/credits-deductions/individuals/child-and-dependent-care-credit-information

3 Homeschooling Help

Free, trusted resources if you choose to homeschool.

☐ Know Your State's Homeschool Law

Rules vary by state. Find the legal requirements where you live before you start.

→ hslda.org/legal

☐ Free Homeschool Curriculum & Libraries

Public libraries and free sites like Khan Academy offer no-cost learning materials.

→ www.khanacademy.org

4 Get Local Help

Free experts who know your area's options.

☐ Child Care Resource & Referral (CCR&R)

Free local experts help you find care and assistance you qualify for. Find yours via [Childcare.gov](https://childcare.gov).

→ childcare.gov/state-resources

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of unlicensed care and of anyone charging a fee to “apply” for child care assistance — the programs above are free to apply for through official state agencies.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Even if you think you earn too much, check the income limits — many working families qualify for at least partial child care help, especially with more than one child in care.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For your state's child care assistance and homeschool rules, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
